



Leek

Clusters of purple flowers grow on stalks up to 3 ft (1 m) tall.



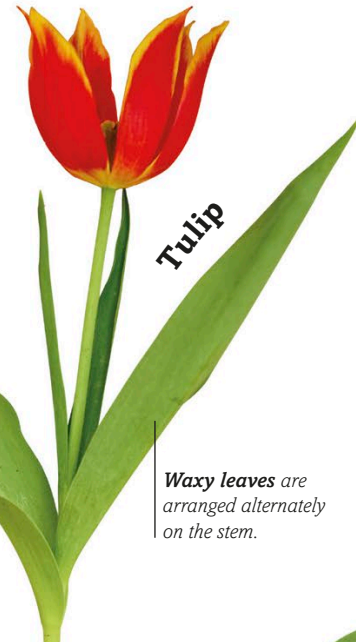
Hyacinth

Balls of flowers can grow 7 in (20 cm) across.

Poisonous bulbs can irritate skin on contact.



Giant onion



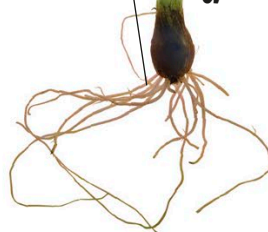
Tulip

Waxy leaves are arranged alternately on the stem.



Dwarf iris

Roots continue to grow and absorb nutrients and moisture during the cool fall season.



Leek bulbs form long, straight white barrels.



Leek bulb

Bulbs multiply as they mature and grow into new plants.

Long roots can pull the bulbs deeper into the soil.



Many South African plants, such as **amaryllises** and **nerines**, spend the hot summer as bulbs under the ground, flowering in the fall when it is cooler. Others, such as **daffodils**, **tulips**, and **hyacinths**, flower in the spring after the cold winter in other countries has ended. These are some of the most

popular blooms, farmed for selling as cut flowers for the home. Although some bulb plants, such as **leeks** and **onions**, are edible, others produce toxic chemicals to discourage animals from digging up the bulbs and eating them. Daffodil, hyacinth, and tulip bulbs are poisonous to many animals.